Semi-Annual Reporting (SAR) Cycle	Number	Page
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Revision Date:
04/01/2022

Background:
Semi-Annual Reporting (SAR) is the simplified reporting option under federal Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) reporting requirements that California elects to use. Recipients are required to submit one Semi-Annual Eligibility Report form (SAR 7) in the 6, 12 ,18 or 24-month interval after the Beginning Date of Aid (BDA).

Purpose:
This section includes policies on SAR household (HH) types, cycles, and alignment responsibilities. This section is being revised to update SAR requirements for Elderly Simplified Application Project (ESAP) HHs.

Policy:
HHs are required to complete a SAR 7. The SAR cycle will be determined by the BDA. The frequency of SAR 7s the HH will be required to submit depends on the HH composition and types of income. The following is terminology used to describe the months and the period of the SAR cycle:

Term	Definition
Data Month	The month for which the HH is required to report all information necessary to determine eligibility.
Submit Month	The month in which the SAR 7 must be submitted.
SAR Payment Period	The period in which benefits are issued. The period that starts with the BDA or the month after the submit month.

1. Determining the SAR Submission Month:
To determine when a SAR 7 must be submitted, eligibility staff must consider the BDA, HH composition and types of income. The following table shows when a SAR 7 form must be completed by each HH type:

HH Type	Certification Period	SAR 7 Frequency
Regular, homeless, and migrant/seasonal farmworker.	12-month	6-months
All adult members are Elderly or Disabled and HH includes non-disabled minor children with **no** earned income.	24-month	12-months
Residing on an Indian Reservation with **no** earned income.	24-month	12-months
All adult members are Elderly or Disabled and HH includes non-disabled minor children **with** earned income.	24-month	6, 12, and 18-months
Residing on an Indian Reservation **with** earned income.	24-month	6, 12, and 18-months
HHs losing ESAP eligibility.	36-month	12 and 24-months

2. SAR Cycles:

The first SAR payment month when actual benefits are issued is the BDA. This includes a subsequent month in which a supplemental payment is made. SAR cycles will be assigned based on the BDA. HH's not eligible in the month of application will have the SAR cycle align with the BDA. Cycles will be assigned as follows:

HH's with a BDA month in …	Will be assigned to cycle …
January or July	One
February or August	Two
March or September	Three
April or October	Four
May or November	Five
June or December	Six

3. Alignment of Cycles:

For Public Assistance CalFresh (PACF) cases, recertification/redetermination dates must be aligned as follows:

If a HH applies for …	Then the cycle/redetermination for …
CalWORKs and is already receiving CalFresh.	CalWORKs must be aligned with the existing CalFresh cycle.
CalFresh and is already receiving CalWORKs.	CalFresh must be aligned with the CalWORKs cycle.

The certification may be for less than 12-months to align with the existing CalWORKs/CalFresh program and must be set at application or recertification. If an existing CalFresh HH has a 24-month certification period, the 1st CalWORKs redetermination will align to CalFresh. The 2nd CalWORKs redetermination will then be aligned with CalFresh recertification at 24-months. Examples on alignment are provided below:

Example: Aligning CalWORKs to existing CalFresh with 12-month certification period	
Scenario	An active CalFresh HH with BDA of 01/10/2020, their next recertification will be 12/2020. HH applied and was approved for CalWORKs on 09/16/2020.
Outcome	The recertification will be modified for the CalWORKs application and will follow the existing CalFresh recertification cycle. Both programs will be renewed on 12/2020 and have matching cycles.

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
CalFresh	BDA											RRR
CalWORKs									BDA			RRR

Example: Aligning CalWORKs to existing CalFresh with 24-month certification period	
Scenario	An active CalFresh HH with BDA of 01/10/2020, their next recertification will be 12/2021. HH applied and was approved for CalWORKs on 09/16/2020.
Outcome	The recertification will be modified for the CalWORKs application, since this is a 24-month certification for CalFresh the first CalWORKs recertification will be aligned to the CalFresh SAR 7. Both programs will be recertified on 12/2021 and have matching cycles.

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
CalFresh	BDA											SAR 7
CalWORKs									BDA			RRR
Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
CalFresh												RRR
CalWORKs												2nd RRR

Example: Aligning CalFresh with 12-month certification period to existing CalWORKs	
Scenario	An active CalWORKs HH with BDA of 04/21/2020, their next recertification will be 03/2021. HH applied and was approved for CalFresh on 10/25/2020.
Outcome	The recertification will be modified for the CalFresh application and will follow the existing CalWORKs recertification cycle. Both programs will be renewed on 03/2021 and have matching cycles.

Month	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar
CalFresh							BDA					RRR
CalWORKs	BDA											RRR

Example: Aligning CalFresh with 24-month certification period to existing CalWORKs:	
Scenario	An active CalWORKs HH with BDA of 04/21/2020, their next recertification will be 03/2021. HH applied and was approved for CalFresh on 10/25/2020.
Outcome	The recertification will be modified for the CalFresh application and will follow the existing CalWORKs recertification cycle. On 03/2021 the HH will be required to be complete a CalWORKs recertification and a CalFresh SAR 7. Both programs will be renewed 03/2022 and have matching cycles.

Month	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar
CalFresh							BDA					SAR 7
CalWORKs	BDA											RRR
Month	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar
CalFresh												RRR
CalWORKs												2nd RRR

Note: Depending on the HH composition, there may be additional SAR 7s at 6 and 18 months.

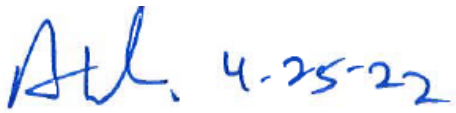
Procedure:
Desk Aid Certification Periods and Submit Months (S:\ENTERPRISE\Food Stamp State Forms\SPOS Folder\Guides Charts & Tables)
Desk Aid SAR Cycle Table (S:\ENTERPRISE\Food Stamp State Forms\SPOS Folder\Guides Charts & Tables)
Desk Aid SAR Payment Periods (S:\ENTERPRISE\Food Stamp State Forms\SPOS Folder\Guides Charts & Tables)

Other Program Impacts:
CalWORKs program

References:
ACL 15-90 and 22-15

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 04/30/2025.

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services